Washington in July 1973. The Security Council debate on the Middle East, which was held around the same time and which ended with an American veto (as Israel had hoped), was the final stroke.

- In May 1973, the American assessment was that despite the low likelihood of an Egyptian military initiative, there was a greater risk of it now than there had been in the past. There was logic in taking military action to break the conflict out of its deadlock. Most of the other options were blocked. Sadat could not expect anything from Brezhnev at the upcoming summit, and Brezhnev would not endanger the détente because of Egypt. Only military action could get the superpowers to take the conflict seriously.
- In June 1973, a European intelligence service assessed that because none of Egypt's diplomatic initiatives had achieved results, and because Egypt was disappointed with the outcomes at the UN, the possibility that Sadat would go to war had to be taken into account.
- In June 1973, a reliable source reported that if the Nixon-Brezhnev summit did not lead to a change in the Middle East, the Egyptians would try to take over Mitla Pass.
- In July 1973, an analysis of the significance of the détente for Egypt was prepared by Ismail Fahmi, then minister of tourism, who immediately after the war (in November 1973) was appointed foreign minister. His conclusions were that Egypt could not expect salvation from either superpower; the Soviet Union "could not and did not want" to bring about a solution, and the United States "could but did not want to." Egypt must strive to reach a state of "autarky" (independence), enlist the support of the Arab countries and the nonaligned countries, and rely on its own political and military capabilities.
- In August 1973, an intelligence report on the public mood stated, inter alia, that concern and tension among Egyptian citizens had recently been increasing as a result of feelings of despair and pessimism about resolving the conflict and the fear for the country's future, especially after recent global developments and their negative implications (this was in reference to the summit and the discussions in the Security Council).